

AI Career Mentor & Consultant

Customer & MVP Blueprint

INDIA · EDTECH · AI-POWERED · B2C + B2B · JUNE 2026

01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

DIMENSION	DETAIL
Startup Idea	Personalised AI-powered career guidance platform for Indian students aged 13–25
Core Problem	580M+ students lack affordable, unbiased, always-on career guidance; counselling costs █5K–█50K/session, metro-concentrated, commission-biased
Solution	AI mentor delivering career reports, skill-gap analysis, learning roadmaps, internship matching & interview prep — sub-█500/yr
Market	India EdTech █3.6–12.1 Bn (2025), CAGR ~28%. TAM USD 1.5 Bn; SAM USD 360 M; SOM USD 1.8 M (Yr 3)
Validation Score	6.7 / 10 composite — GO with conditions. Run 20 interviews + █99 landing page test within 30 days.
Recommendation	█ PROMISING BUT UNVALIDATED — Strong problem, fragmented competition, but WTP unconfirmed. Validate before building.

02 IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE (ICP)

B2C — PRIMARY: Individual Student	B2B — SECONDARY: Institutional Buyer
Age 15–22 (sweet spot: Class 10 → 2nd yr college) Geo: Tier 1–3 India (incl. Lucknow, Jaipur, Patna) Device: Android-first, 4G/5G Pain: Confused on stream/career path WTP: █199–█999/yr █299–█499 one-time Discovery: YouTube, Instagram, peer referral	Segment: Private schools (Cl 8–12), colleges, coaching Decision maker: Principal / Academic Director Size: 500–5,000 students Budget: █20K–█1.5L/yr Trigger: NEP 2020 compliance, parent demand Sales cycle: 4–8 weeks; demo + pilot required

03 BUYER PERSONAS

PERSONA	PROFILE	GOAL / FEAR	WTP
█ Aryan, 17 Confused Stream Chooser	Lucknow UP · Class 11 PCM YouTube late-night career research Asks seniors on Reddit	Goal: Know if Engg is right or explore Design/Finance Fear: 'Wrong stream = 4 wasted years'	█299 one-time █499/yr sub
█ Priya, 20 Placem ent-Anxious College Junior	Pune · B.Com 2nd yr Consumes LinkedIn; buys Udemy but doesn't finish Placement season in 18 months	Goal: Finance or Data role; needs skill roadmap Fear: 'Everyone else is more prepared'	█799/yr with course roadmap + interview prep

PERSONA	PROFILE	GOAL / FEAR	WTP
■■■ Mrs. Sharma Anxious Parent	Kanpur UP · Mother of CI 10 student Middle-income; attends education fairs Trusts teachers & relatives	Goal: Right career stream for child Fear: 'We can't afford wasted time/money'	■■999–■■2,499 one-time family plan

04 TOP 10 CUSTOMER PAIN POINTS

#	PAIN POINT	SEVERITY	CURRENT (BROKEN) FIX
1	Don't know what career suits me	■ Critical	Google, parents — biased & generic
2	Good counselling is unaffordable (■■5K–■■50K)	■ Critical	Skip it entirely
3	No counsellors in my city (Tier-2/3)	■ Critical	WhatsApp groups, YouTube
4	Don't know which skills to build	■ High	Random Udemy courses, no roadmap
5	Worried about campus placements	■ High	Coaching centres, seniors — inconsistent
6	Parents push Engg/Medicine; I want alternatives	■ High	Family conflict — no data to counter
7	Career advice is one-time, not ongoing	■ High	Repeat consultations cost more
8	Internship access is opaque & network-gated	■ Medium	LinkedIn cold outreach, job portals
9	Can't tell if I'm on track with skill building	■ Medium	No accountability partner
10	Interview prep is expensive / unstructured	■ Medium	YouTube, mock sessions with peers

05 CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP

STAGE	ACTION	EMOTION	PLATFORM ROLE	KEY FEATURE
1. AWARENESS	Searches 'career after Class 12'; sees peer succeed	■ Anxious	SEO + content + school partnerships	Free Career Quiz / Blog
2. CONSIDERATION	Compares platforms, reads reviews, watches demo	■ Curious	Free trial; clear value prop	Free 5-min Assessment Preview
3. ACTIVATION	Completes full intake: interests, skills, goals	■ Hopeful	Deliver wow moment — personalised report	AI Career Report (■■0 or ■■99)
4. ENGAGEMENT	Follows learning roadmap; checks skill tracker weekly	■ Motivated	Habit loop: progress nudges, micro-goals	Skill Roadmap + Dashboard
5. CONVERSION	Unlocks full features: interview prep, internships	■ Committed	Frictionless upgrade at value moment	Pro Plan — ■499/yr
6. ADVOCACY	Shares report with friends; recommends to juniors	■ Proud	Referral programme; shareable career card	Refer & Earn

06 KEY OBJECTIONS & BUYING TRIGGERS

■ BUYING TRIGGERS	■ OBJECTIONS → RESPONSE
• Board exam results (Class 10/12) • College placement season opens • Peer/sibling gets placed well • Admission season stress (June–August) • School announces career fair • Parent asks 'What will you do?' • Teacher recommends a career tool	'AI advice isn't trustworthy' → Show expert validation badge + free trial report 'Free alternatives exist' → Demo 50-point skill-gap vs generic YouTube 'Parents need to approve' → Launch Parent Report view + family plan pricing 'I'll try it after exams' → Offer locked free tier; no urgency pressure 'Might be biased toward colleges' → Zero Institutional Partnership pledge

07 MVP RECOMMENDATION

BUILD FIRST ■	DO NOT BUILD YET ■	SUCCESS METRICS ■
• Intake form (interests, academics, goals) • AI-generated personalised career report (■99) • Top 3 career paths with skill-gap analysis • Basic learning roadmap (curated free links) • Simple mobile-first web app (PWA) • Email delivery of report	• Native iOS/Android app • Internship marketplace • Live human counsellor integration • Psychometric battery (full) • B2B school portal • Vernacular languages • Interview simulator • Community / forum	• 15%+ landing page → ■99 payment conversion • NPS ≥ 40 after first report • 3+ organic referrals from first 10 users • 10 paying users in Month 1 • Avg report delivery < 48 hrs • 40%+ open rate on progress nudge emails

08 MoSCoW PRIORITIZATION

■ MUST HAVE	■ SHOULD HAVE	■ COULD HAVE	■ WON'T HAVE (v1)
• AI career report generation	• Skill-gap analysis display	• Parent report view	• Native mobile app
• Intake: interests, skills, academics	• Learning roadmap (free courses)	• Vernacular UI (Hindi)	• Live counsellor chat
• ■99 payment gateway	• Progress tracker dashboard	• Career path comparison tool	• Full psychometric test
• Mobile-first responsive UI	• Referral / share feature	• Push notification nudges	• B2B school admin portal
• PDF report download	• Basic onboarding email sequence	• Internship listings (curated)	• AI interview simulator

09 PRICING HYPOTHESIS

TIER	PRICE	WHAT'S INCLUDED	TARGET	RATIONALE
Free	■0	3-question mini quiz + 1-page teaser report	All students	Hook; viral entry point
Starter Report	■99 one-time	Full AI career report (50-pt analysis) + top 3 paths	Class 10–12 students	Low-friction WTP test; impulse buy
Pro Annual	■499/yr	Report + skill roadmap + progress tracker + interview tips	College students	Core revenue driver; high LTV
Family Plan	■999 one-time	Pro report for student + Parent Report view	Parents paying	Unlock parent budget holder
B2B School	■20K–■1.5L/yr	White-label portal + bulk student reports + admin dashboard	Institutions	Scale revenue from Yr 2; sticky

10 TOP 5 RISKS

#	RISK	PROB	IMPACT	MITIGATION
1	AI hallucinated / wrong career advice damages trust	Medium	■ Critical	Human expert review layer; confidence scores; free retry
2	Low willingness-to-pay — students expect free content	Medium	■ High	Freemium hook; B2B as primary revenue; parent pricing tier
3	Well-funded competitor launches pure-AI product	High	■ High	Lock in B2B school contracts early (sticky); build India-specific career data moat
4	Solo founder burnout before product-market fit	High	■ High	Add 1 advisor in 60 days; use AI/no-code to extend capacity; set weekly limits
5	DPDP Act 2023 compliance gap (student data)	Low-Med	■ Critical	Privacy-by-design from Day 1; minimal data collection; appoint DPO early

11 30-DAY MVP PLAN

WEEK	FOCUS	ACTIONS	SUCCESS METRIC
Week 1 Days 1–7	Customer Discovery	• 20 student interviews (friends, peers, LinkedIn DMs) • 5 school counsellor / principal interviews • Document top 5 verbatim pain quotes	20 interviews done 5 recurring themes Problem hypothesis confirmed
Week 2 Days 8–14	Demand Test	• Build 1-page landing page (Carrd / Webflow) • Add ■99 pre-order CTA + sample report preview • Share with 200+ via WhatsApp, Instagram, college groups	200+ page visits 15%+ → ■99 payment = GREEN LIGHT 5–10% = pivot pricing
Week 3 Days 15–21	Manual MVP	• Build AI report via GPT API + Google Form intake • Manually deliver 10 personalised reports to waitlist • Collect NPS + qualitative feedback from each user	10 reports in < 48 hrs NPS ≥ 40 3+ shareable testimonials
Week 4 Days 22–30	Iterate & Plan	• Analyse feedback; identify top 3 product improvements • Approach 3 local schools for free pilot • Draft 3-month roadmap; decide build vs. expand manual service	1 school LOI signed Product iterations prioritised Funding / bootstrap decision made

12 FOUNDER ACTION SHEET — TOP 10 NEXT ACTIONS

#	ACTION	DEADLINE	OWNER
1	Conduct 20 student interviews using structured script (pain, WTP, current fix)	Day 7	Founder
2	Build 1-page landing page with ■99 pre-order CTA (Carrd or Webflow — zero code)	Day 10	Founder
3	Post landing page across 5 WhatsApp groups, Instagram story, 3 college Reddit threads	Day 11	Founder
4	Manually create 3 sample AI career reports using GPT-4o + Google Form intake	Day 14	Founder
5	Reach out to 5 school principals in Lucknow / nearby cities for free pilot interest	Day 14	Founder
6	Identify and contact 1 domain expert (HR/psychometrics) to join as unpaid advisor	Day 20	Founder
7	Deliver 10 personalised reports to first paying users; collect NPS scores	Day 21	Founder

#	ACTION	DEADLINE	OWNER
8	Publish 1 SEO blog post: 'Best career options after Class 12 in 2026' (Hindi + English)	Day 21	Founder
9	Analyse all feedback; write a 1-page decision memo: build full app OR scale manual	Day 28	Founder
10	Set North Star KPI dashboard: page visits, ₹99 conversions, NPS, referral count	Day 30	Founder

13 SCORES (0–100)

82	88	72	65
Customer Clarity	Problem Severity	PMF Potential	MVP Readiness

SCORE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
Customer Clarity 82/100	You know exactly who your customer is and where to find them	Start interviews immediately — you have the access
Problem Severity 88/100	Pain is real, frequent, and expensive — classic strong signal	Lead with cost + access gap in all messaging
PMF Potential 72/100	Good potential but WTP is unconfirmed — the critical unknown	Run the ₹99 landing page test before writing any code
MVP Readiness 65/100	Technically feasible but no validation yet; solo execution risk	Use GPT API + Google Form for v0; skip app development

14 FINAL VERDICT

■ PROMISING BUT UNVALIDATED

SIGNAL	STRENGTH	EVIDENCE
Problem Demand	■ Strong	9/10 problem validity; 580M underserved students; cost barrier confirmed
Market Timing	■ Strong	~28% CAGR; NEP 2020 tailwind; AI adoption accelerating in India
Competition Gap	■ Strong	No pure-play AI-first platform covering ages 13–25 affordably
WTP Evidence	■ Weak	No paying users yet; ₹99 landing page test NOT yet run — critical gap
Founder Fit	■ Good	7/10 FMF; lived experience is powerful; domain depth gap needs advisor
Execution Risk	■ Watch	Solo founder; no team; high burnout risk without support structure

■ Advisor Note: The biggest risk is NOT competition — it's building before confirming students will pay. Run the 30-day plan with full intensity. If 15%+ of landing page visitors pay ₹99, begin MVP immediately. You ARE your own customer — every peer conversation is market research. Go validate it.